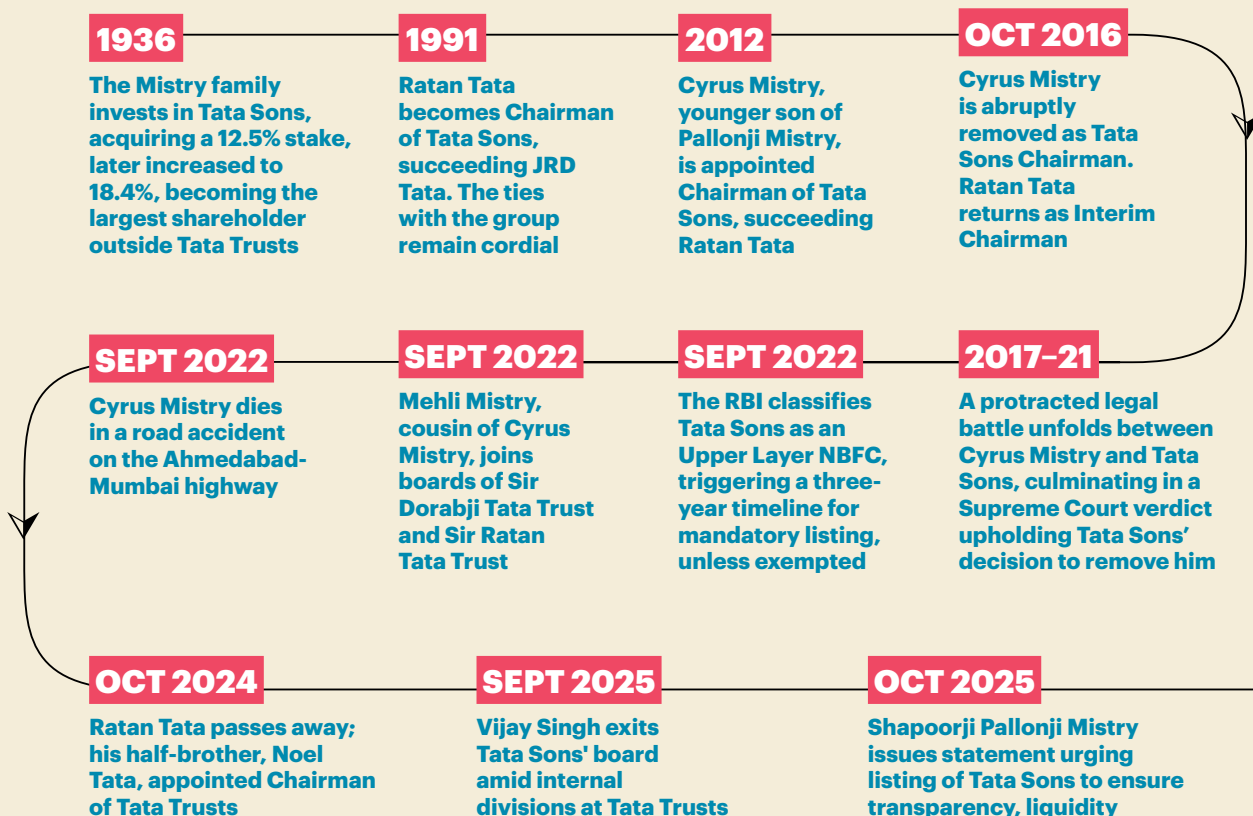


THE TATA-MISTRY SAGA

THE SP GROUP HAS STOOD BY THE TATA GROUP THROUGH THICK AND THIN. NOW, IT SAYS A LISTING OF TATA SONS WILL PAVE THE WAY FOR A “ROBUST AND EQUITABLE DIVIDEND POLICY”



from the SP Group's standpoint, also align with what Mistry described as "the truest form of respect for both legacy and the future" transparency.

THE REGULATORY CROSSROADS

Overlaying this financial tension is a regulatory deadline that cannot be ignored. In September 2022, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) designated Tata Sons an "Upper Layer" non-banking financial company (NBFC), placing it among the most systemically significant such institutions in the country. Under RBI's scale-based framework, entities in this category must list within three years of such a categorisation, unless granted an exemption or deregis-

tration. That compliance deadline ended on September 30, 2025.

The SP Group's statement made direct reference to this timeline, expressing faith in the RBI's ability to "act in accordance with the rule of law and the spirit of fairness." It added that the regulator's framework "clearly articulates that a non-banking financial company should not act in a manner detrimental to the interests of its investors."

Yet, the Tata Group has sought deregistration, arguing that Tata Sons is not engaged in lending and, therefore, should not be regulated as an NBFC.

Eminent tax lawyer Homi Ranina believes Tata Sons